

Blue Harbor Software — Employee Handbook (2026 Edition)

Welcome to Blue Harbor Software. This handbook summarizes our policies, benefits, and expectations. It is not a contract of employment. Where this handbook conflicts with a signed agreement or applicable law, those prevail. Questions go to People Operations at **people@blueharbor.example**.

1. Employment Basics

Blue Harbor is an at-will employer. Standard full-time hours are **40 per week**. Core collaboration hours are **10:00 AM to 3:00 PM local time**; outside those hours, schedules are flexible. New employees serve a **90-day introductory period** during which either party may end employment with minimal notice.

2. Remote & Hybrid Work

Blue Harbor is **remote-first**. Employees may work from anywhere within a country where we have a legal entity (currently the U.S., Canada, and Portugal). If you relocate, notify People Ops **at least 30 days in advance**, as it may affect payroll and taxes. Teams may designate up to **four in-person gathering weeks** per year; travel for these is company-paid.

Home Office Stipend

Full-time employees receive a **one-time \$1,000 home-office stipend** and a **\$60/month internet reimbursement**. Keep receipts for anything over \$75.

3. Paid Time Off (PTO)

Blue Harbor offers **flexible (uncapped) PTO** for salaried employees, with an expectation that everyone takes **at least 15 days per year**. PTO must be approved by your manager and logged in Rippling. Because PTO is uncapped, **it does not accrue and is not paid out** at termination.

Hourly employees accrue PTO at **1.5 days per month** (18 days/year), which does carry over and is paid out on separation, up to a cap of 30 days.

4. Holidays

The company observes **12 paid holidays** per year, listed each January in the People Ops calendar. In addition, employees get **two "floating holidays"** to use for occasions meaningful to them. The office (and Slack) goes quiet during our **year-end shutdown from December 24 to January 1**, which does not count against PTO.

5. Sick Leave & Family Leave

Salaried employees use flexible PTO for illness. Hourly employees have a separate bank of **7 paid sick days** per year.

New parents receive **16 weeks of fully paid parental leave**, available to all parents regardless of gender, to be taken within 12 months of birth or adoption. Leave can be taken continuously or split into up to three blocks.

6. Benefits

- **Health insurance:** Company pays 90% of the employee premium and 60% of dependent premiums on the base PPO plan. Coverage starts on your **first day** (no waiting period).
- **Dental & vision:** Fully paid for the employee.
- **Retirement:** 401(k) with a **4% company match**, vested immediately.
- **Life insurance:** 1x annual salary, company-paid.
- **Learning budget:** **\$1,500 per year** for courses, books, or conferences.
- **Wellness:** \$50/month wellness reimbursement (gym, apps, therapy copays).

7. Compensation & Reviews

Salaries are reviewed annually each **April**. Performance reviews happen twice a year (April and October) on a 5-point scale. Promotions can occur at any cycle. Referral bonuses are **\$3,000** per hired referral, paid after the new hire's 90th day.

8. Expenses & Travel

Submit expenses in Ramp within **30 days**. Pre-approval is required for any single expense over **\$500**. Standard travel: economy airfare, mid-tier hotels, and a **\$65/day meal per diem**. Rideshare is preferred over rental cars for trips under three days. Alcohol is not reimbursable except at pre-approved company events.

9. Equipment & Security

Each employee receives a company laptop. **Full-disk encryption and the company password manager are mandatory.** Never store customer data on personal devices. Report a lost device to security@blueharbor.example **within 24 hours.** Multi-factor authentication is required on all company accounts. Phishing tests are run quarterly.

10. Code of Conduct

We expect professionalism and respect. Harassment, discrimination, and retaliation are prohibited and grounds for termination. Report concerns to your manager, People Ops, or the anonymous ethics line at **1-800-555-0143**. All reports are investigated; retaliation against a good-faith reporter is itself a violation.

11. Confidentiality & IP

Employees sign a confidentiality and invention-assignment agreement at hire. Do not share non-public company or customer information. Work created within the scope of employment belongs to the company. Public speaking or writing about your work requires a quick heads-up to Communications.

12. Leaving Blue Harbor

We ask for **two weeks' notice**. On your last day, return all equipment. Final pay, including any accrued-and-owed hourly PTO, is issued on the next regular payroll date. Your health coverage continues through the **end of the month** of your departure, after which COBRA options are provided. We conduct optional exit interviews and genuinely value the feedback.

This handbook is reviewed annually. Last updated January 2026. For anything not covered here, ask People Ops.